

VERTICAL FORESTS

ECO BUILDINGS

In many places around the world, vehicles and industry emit harmful gases and particles of pollution in the air that can lead to health risks when inhaled. Some eco-friendly buildings in cities are designed to act as urban air purifiers. The towers of Bosco Verticale (meaning “vertical forest”) in Milan, Italy, have many plants on their outsides. These catch polluting particles and absorb carbon dioxide gas to use in a process called photosynthesis. This gas contributes to climate change (see page 156).

SMOG-FREE TOWER

This aluminum tower in Rotterdam, the Netherlands, acts like a vacuum cleaner for smog. Designed to work in parks, it sucks up air, removes tiny polluting particles, and releases clean air. Highly energy-efficient, it uses almost the same amount of power as a coffee maker.



PHOTOSYNTHESIS

Plants need carbon dioxide to grow. Their leaves convert it into energy and oxygen using water and sunlight in a reaction called photosynthesis. A plant's waxy leaves also have a big and sticky surface area for trapping very small polluting particles.

